

What Is a Period?

Menstruation, often called a period, is normal vaginal bleeding that happens as part of a girl or woman's monthly cycle. The beginning of a period marks the start of a young girl's menstrual journey and is often seen as an important step in growing up.

Every month, the body prepares for pregnancy. If pregnancy does not happen, the womb (uterus) sheds its lining. This lining leaves the body as menstrual blood, which is made up of blood and tissue from inside the uterus.

Periods can start as early as age 9 and usually continue until menopause, around age 51. Most periods last about 3 to 5 days, but some may last up to 7 days.

Many girls get their first period around age 11, but it can start earlier or later. Everyone's body is different, and each person develops on their own schedule.

It's normal to feel a little shy about sharing this news. In some families, it can feel hard to talk about body changes. Even so, it's important to tell at least one trusted adult, such as a parent or caregiver. If siblings find out and tease you, you can simply let them know it means you're growing older.

Why Do Girls Get Periods?

Periods happen because of hormone changes in the body. These hormones tell the uterus to prepare for pregnancy by building up its lining. This lining is where a fertilized egg could grow into a baby.

If pregnancy doesn't happen, the lining breaks down and leaves the body as menstrual bleeding. This process repeats each month, which is why most girls and women have periods about once a month.

How Often Do Periods Happen?

Most periods happen once a month. During the first few years after a girl starts menstruating, periods may not be regular—and that's completely normal.

By about three years after the first period, most girls' cycles settle into a more regular monthly pattern.

How Long Do Periods Last?

Periods usually last between 3 and 5 days, though some may last a bit longer.

How Much Blood Comes Out During a Period?

It may look like a lot of blood, but most girls only lose a few tablespoons of blood over the entire period.

Final Thoughts

Periods are a natural and healthy part of life. They should not stop you from having fun, going to school, or enjoying everyday activities.

If you have questions about your period, talk to a doctor, nurse, parent, or trusted family member. You can also send questions to us at **care@yarrow.com**.